



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Faith, Kindness & Courage Study Workbook

Building Christlike Character for Real Teenage Pressures - A Study for
Ages 13-19

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Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Being a teenager means constant pressure - to fit in, stay quiet, and go along. This six-unit study builds three anchors of Christlike character: faith that holds when you can't see, kindness that costs something, and courage that stands firm. Expect honesty, Scripture, and real application.

HEBREWS 12:1

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Faith When You Can't See

"Faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see."

- Hebrews 11:1

Unit Overview

Faith is not blind or irrational; it is trust based on who God has proven to be. This unit defines real faith and separates it from wishful thinking.

DEVOTIONAL

Trust Isn't Blind

People treat faith like crossing your fingers and hoping. The Bible describes it very differently.

HEBREWS 11:1

"Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see."

Biblical faith is confidence based on evidence and relationship, not a leap into the dark. You trust a friend you know; you trust God the same way.

Doubt is not the opposite of faith - refusal to trust is. Honest doubt, brought to God, often deepens faith.

Reflect

1. What do you think most people mean by 'faith'? How is the Bible's definition different?

2. Where do you find it hardest to trust God right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow real, evidence-based trust in me, especially where I can't see.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Hall of Faith

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

HEBREWS 11:6-8

"And without faith it is impossible to please God, because anyone who comes to him must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who earnestly seek him. By faith Noah, when warned about things not yet seen, in holy fear built an ark to save his family. By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things must someone believe to come to God?

2. What did Noah do by faith?

3. What did Abraham not know?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Hall of Faith

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does obedience often come before understanding?

2. How is faith connected to action here?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where is God asking you to obey before you fully understand?

2. What 'ark' or step of faith is in front of you?

WORD STUDY

Faith

MEANING

Trust and reliance on God - believing he is who he says and acting on it.

Where It Appears**2 CORINTHIANS 5:7**

"We live by faith, not by sight."

ROMANS 10:17

"Faith comes from hearing the message, through the word about Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. If faith comes from hearing God's word, how should that shape your habits?

2. What is the difference between believing about God and trusting God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Faith, Honestly


Rate your trust in God right now and explain why.


What doubt have you been afraid to admit?


What would help your faith grow?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Faith vs. Science?

THE QUESTION

Do you have to choose between believing in God and accepting science?

Think It Through**Different questions**

Science asks how the universe works; faith asks why it exists and what it means.

Believing scientists

Many leading scientists across history have been people of faith.

Not blind

Christian faith invites investigation; it is not threatened by honest questions.

Your Response

1. Have you felt pressure to choose between faith and science? Describe it.

2. What question about faith and science do you most want answered?

UNIT 2

Kindness That Costs Something

"Be kind and compassionate to one another." - Ephesians 4:32

Unit Overview

Real kindness is more than being nice; it is choosing others' good even when it's inconvenient. This unit explores compassion, generosity, and forgiveness.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than Being Nice

Nice avoids conflict. Kindness moves toward people, sometimes into discomfort, for their good.

EPHESIANS 4:32

"Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you."

Notice kindness is tied to forgiveness here - the hardest kind, extended to people who hurt us.

The model is not our mood but the cross: 'just as God forgave you.' Kindness flows from grace received.

Reflect

1. Who is hard for you to be kind to right now?

2. How does remembering God's forgiveness of you change that?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, make me kind the way you are kind - even when it costs me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Good Samaritan

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

LUKE 10:33-37

"But a Samaritan, as he traveled, came where the man was; and when he saw him, he took pity on him. He went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. Then he put the man on his own donkey, brought him to an inn and took care of him. The next day he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper. 'Look after him,' he said, 'and when I return, I will reimburse you for any extra expense.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does the Samaritan do when he sees the man?

2. List everything it cost him.

3. Who was the Samaritan to the Jews of that day?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Good Samaritan

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus make the hero someone his audience despised?

2. What does this teach about who our 'neighbor' is?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who is a 'neighbor' you have walked past?

2. What would costly kindness look like this week?

WORD STUDY

Compassion

MEANING

To be moved deeply by another's suffering - literally, to 'suffer with' - and to act on it.

Where It Appears**PSALM 145:8**

"The Lord is gracious and compassionate, slow to anger."

COLOSSIANS 3:12

"Clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between pity and compassion?

2. Whose suffering are you tempted to ignore?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Acts of Real Kindness


When has someone's kindness changed a hard day for you?


Who around you is hurting and easy to overlook?


What is one costly, quiet kindness you could do?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Kindness on Purpose

Kindness rarely happens by accident. Plan it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Do a kind act for someone who cannot repay you.
- ☐ Forgive someone - at least in your own heart - this week.
- ☐ Include someone who is usually left out.
- ☐ Encourage someone specifically, not generically.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 3

Courage Under Pressure

"Be on your guard; stand firm in the faith; be courageous; be strong." - 1 Corinthians 16:13

Unit Overview

Teens face intense pressure to conform. This unit studies standing firm with courage, drawing on Daniel and his friends.

DEVOTIONAL

Standing Alone

Sooner or later everyone faces the choice to go along with the crowd or stand on conviction.

DANIEL 3:18

"But even if he does not, we want you to know, Your Majesty, that we will not serve your gods."

Daniel's friends trusted God to rescue them - but decided to obey even if he didn't. That is mature courage.

Courage is not certainty of the outcome; it is faithfulness regardless of it.

Reflect

1. Where do you feel pressure to compromise your convictions?

2. Could you say 'but even if he does not' and still obey?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me courage to stand even when it's costly and lonely.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Fiery Furnace

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 3:16-18

"Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego replied to him, 'King Nebuchadnezzar, we do not need to defend ourselves before you in this matter. If we are thrown into the blazing furnace, the God we serve is able to deliver us from it, and he will deliver us from Your Majesty's hand. But even if he does not, we want you to know, Your Majesty, that we will not serve your gods or worship the image of gold you have set up.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What choice are the three men facing?

2. What do they believe God is able to do?

3. What is their decision if he doesn't?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Fiery Furnace

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is 'but even if he does not' so important?

2. How do they balance faith and realism?

Application - What will I do?

1. What 'furnace' might your convictions cost you?

2. Where do you need this kind of resolve?

WORD STUDY

Conviction

MEANING

A settled belief you will act on even under pressure - the backbone of courageous character.

Where It Appears**PSALM 1:1**

"Blessed is the one who does not walk in step with the wicked."

ROMANS 12:2

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed."

Dig Deeper

1. What convictions have you actually decided in advance?

2. How do people without settled convictions tend to make decisions?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Pressure Points


Where do you feel the most pressure to conform?


What conviction do you want to settle before you're tested?


Who stands with you, and who could?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Standing firm is easier together. Be real about the pressures you face.

1. What pressures do people our age face that adults underestimate?

2. When have you stood firm - or wished you had?

3. How can this group have each other's backs?

UNIT 4

Faith That Endures Doubt

"I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!" - Mark 9:24

Unit Overview

Doubt is normal and not the end of faith. This unit teaches how to bring doubt to God honestly and let it deepen rather than destroy belief.

DEVOTIONAL

Honest Doubt

Some of the most faithful people in the Bible had serious doubts - and God did not reject them for it.

MARK 9:24

"Immediately the boy's father exclaimed, 'I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!'"

This father does not hide his mixed heart; he brings both his faith and his doubt to Jesus. And Jesus responds.

You do not have to choose between faith and honesty. Bring the doubt to God, not around him.

Reflect

1. What doubts have you felt you had to hide?

2. How would it feel to bring them honestly to God?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, I believe; help my unbelief. Meet me in my questions.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Thomas and Evidence

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 20:27-29

"Then he said to Thomas, 'Put your finger here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe.' Thomas said to him, 'My Lord and my God!' Then Jesus told him, 'Because you have seen me, you have believed; blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus offer Thomas?

2. How does Thomas respond?

3. Who does Jesus call blessed?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Thomas and Evidence

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why might Jesus meet Thomas's doubt with evidence rather than rebuke?

2. What does this say about honest questions?

Application - What will I do?

1. What evidence has God given you to trust him?

2. What doubt do you need to bring into the light?

WORD STUDY

Assurance

MEANING

A settled confidence in God's promises, grounded in his character and work, not in our feelings.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:28**

"We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him."

2 TIMOTHY 1:12

"I know whom I have believed, and am convinced that he is able."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between feelings and assurance?

2. How can you build assurance in seasons you don't 'feel' God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Questions


Write your three biggest questions about faith.


Who could help you explore them honestly?


What would it look like to keep trusting while you search?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

What About Other Religions?

THE QUESTION

How can Christians claim to be right when so many religions disagree?

Think It Through**Not all the same**

Religions make genuinely different, often contradictory claims - they can't all be equally true.

A person, not just a system

Christianity centers on a historical person who claimed and demonstrated authority.

Humble confidence

Believing something is true doesn't require arrogance toward those who differ.

Your Response

1. How would you kindly talk about faith with a friend of another religion?

2. What question about other religions do you still have?

UNIT 5

Courageous Kindness in Action

"Let us not love with words or speech but with actions and in truth." - 1 John 3:18

Unit Overview

This unit fuses the three themes: faith gives roots, kindness gives direction, courage gives follow-through. Together they form Christlike character.

DEVOTIONAL

Love With Skin On

Faith, kindness, and courage are not separate virtues; they meet whenever you do a hard, loving thing.

1 JOHN 3:18

"Dear children, let us not love with words or speech but with actions and in truth."

It is easy to post about love and hard to practice it. John pushes us from talk to action.

Courageous kindness - standing up for someone, serving quietly, telling the truth in love - is faith made visible.

Reflect

1. Where has your love been mostly words lately?

2. What action would make it real?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, turn my faith into love that people can actually see and feel.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Faith Expressed in Love

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GALATIANS 5:6B, 13-14

"The only thing that counts is faith expressing itself through love... You, my brothers and sisters, were called to be free. But do not use your freedom to indulge the flesh; rather, serve one another humbly in love. For the entire law is fulfilled in keeping this one command: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How is genuine faith expressed?

2. What are we told not to do with freedom?

3. What sums up the whole law?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Faith Expressed in Love

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul link faith and love so tightly?

2. How is serving others a use of freedom, not a loss of it?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who has God put near you to serve?

2. What would loving your neighbor look like this week?

WORD STUDY

Integrity

MEANING

Being the same person in private and public - whole and undivided in character.

Where It Appears**PSALM 15:2-4**

"The one whose walk is blameless... who keeps an oath even when it hurts."

PROVERBS 10:9

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely."

Dig Deeper

1. Where is it tempting to be a different person online than in person?

2. What does 'keeping an oath even when it hurts' cost?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Person I'm Becoming

Which do you most need to grow in: faith, kindness, or courage? Why?

Describe the kind of person you want to be at 25.

What is one habit that would move you toward that person?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

All Three, One Week

Put faith, kindness, and courage into a single week of practice.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Faith: start each day with one honest prayer.
- ☐ Kindness: do one costly kind act.
- ☐ Courage: do one right thing you're afraid to do.
- ☐ Integrity: make your private life match your public words once where it's slipping.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

A Character That Lasts

"The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control." - Galatians 5:22-23

Unit Overview

Character is not built in a day; it is grown by the Spirit over time. This unit looks at the fruit of the Spirit as the long-term goal.

DEVOTIONAL

Fruit, Not Fireworks

Fireworks are impressive and gone in seconds. Fruit grows slowly and feeds people. Character is fruit.

GALATIANS 5:22-23

"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control."

Notice it is 'fruit,' not 'achievements.' You do not manufacture character; you grow it as you stay connected to God.

You cannot force fruit, but you can tend the conditions: staying close to Jesus, obeying in small things, and giving it time.

Reflect

1. Which fruit is most evident in your life? Which is least?

2. What 'conditions' in your life help or hurt your growth?

PRAYER PROMPT

Holy Spirit, grow lasting fruit in me. I want to be tended, not just impressive.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Remaining in the Vine

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 15:4-5

"Remain in me, as I also remain in you. No branch can bear fruit by itself; it must remain in the vine. Neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in me. I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What must a branch do to bear fruit?

2. What is the vine? The branches?

3. What can we do apart from Jesus?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Remaining in the Vine

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'remain in me' practically involve?

2. Why is fruit impossible on our own?

Application - What will I do?

1. What helps you 'remain' in Jesus day to day?

2. What disconnects you, and how will you address it?

WORD STUDY

Self-Control

MEANING

The Spirit-empowered ability to govern your desires rather than be ruled by them.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 25:28**

"Like a city whose walls are broken through is a person who lacks self-control."

2 TIMOTHY 1:7

"God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power, love and self-control."

Dig Deeper

1. Where do you most lack self-control right now?

2. How is self-control a gift from the Spirit rather than pure willpower?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Growing Season


Which fruit do you most want God to grow in you this year?


What have you learned about yourself in this study?


Write a prayer for lasting character.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The last discussion. Look ahead at the character you're building.

1. Which of faith, kindness, or courage will be hardest to keep practicing?

2. What is your plan to keep growing after this book?

3. How can this group keep encouraging each other's character?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

HEBREWS 11:1

"Hebrews 11:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Hebrews 11:1

Write out from memory: Ephesians 4:32

Write out from memory: 1 Corinthians 16:13

Write out from memory: 1 John 3:18

Write out from memory: Galatians 5:22-23

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection


Which theme - faith, kindness, or courage - do you most want to carry forward?


How has your character been challenged and shaped in this study?


Write a prayer about the person God is growing you to be.

NOTES

Study Notes

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